Olympics & World Database

How did Olympic success evolve from 1984 to 2020?

Spring 2026 CSUF

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Project Goal

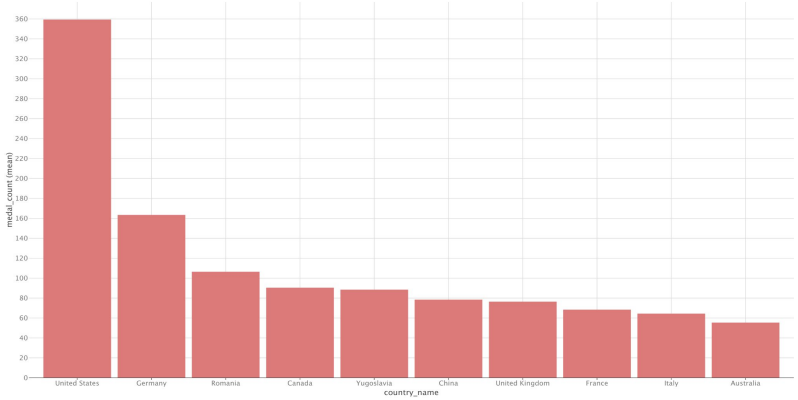
- Database consultants for the UN to investigate world data
- Base Tables: Country, City, CountryLangauge
- Added Tables: Olympics, Sport, Athlete, Medal
- Source: Olympedia & Kaggle
- Central Question: How has global athletic competition changed from 1984 to 2020, and which countries benefited most from those changes?

Rise and Fall of Athletic Superpowers

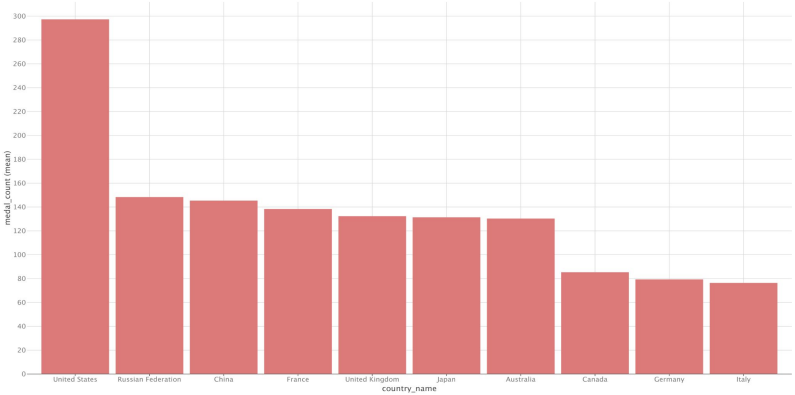
Olympic power remained concentrated, but the countries at the top changed between 1984 and 2020.

Which countries won the most medals in 1984 & 2020 ?

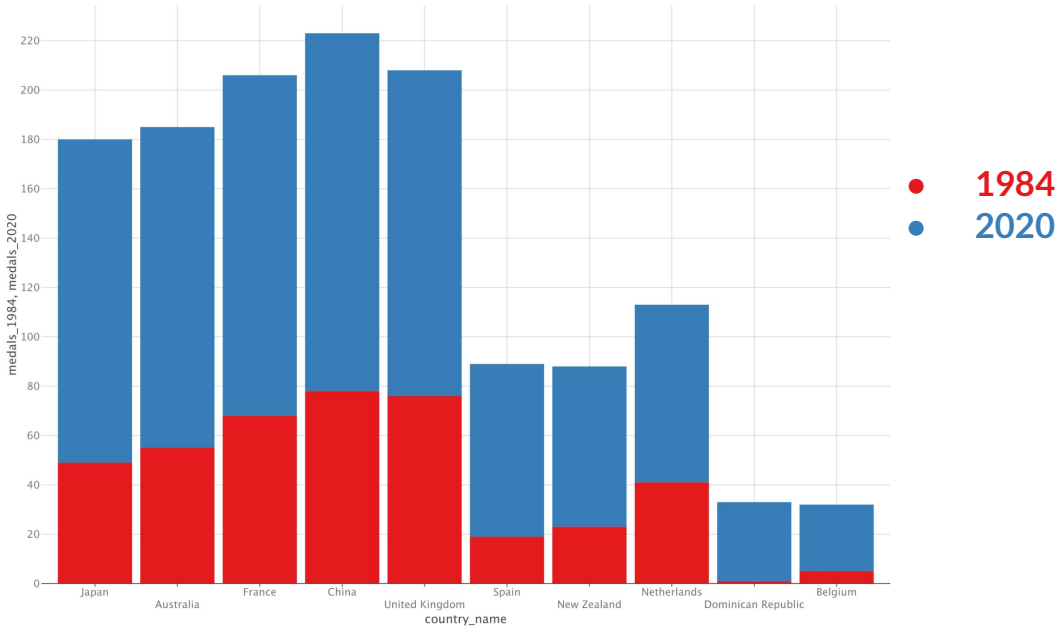
1984



2020



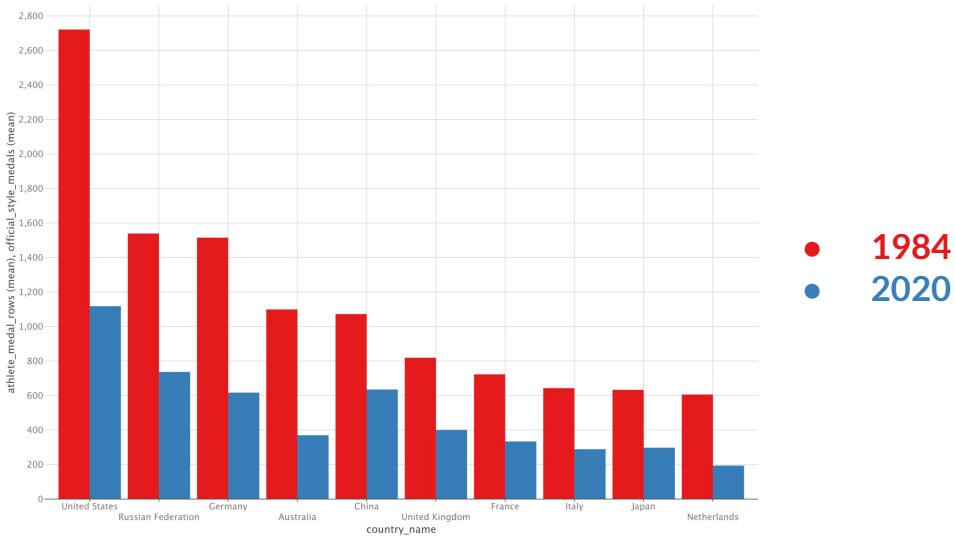
Most improved countries?



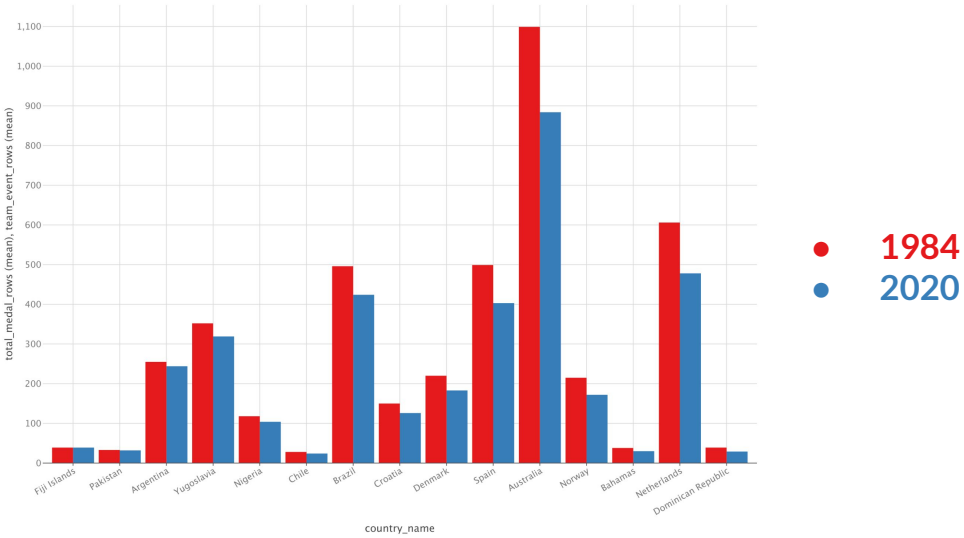
Medal Counts Can Mislead

The way medals are stored in the database affects how Olympic dominance appears.

How do athlete medal rows compare to official-style medal counts?



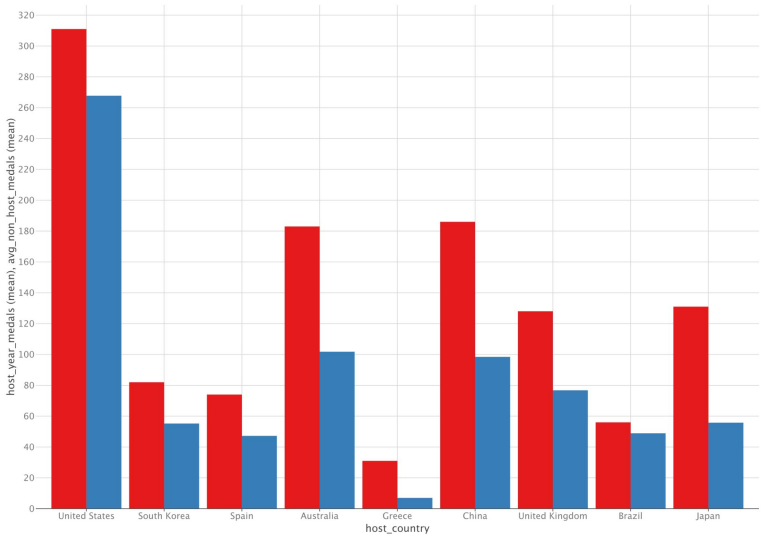
Which countries benefit most from team-event medal rows?



Host Country Advantage

Hosting the Olympics often gives countries a measurable performance boost.

Do host countries win more medals when they host?

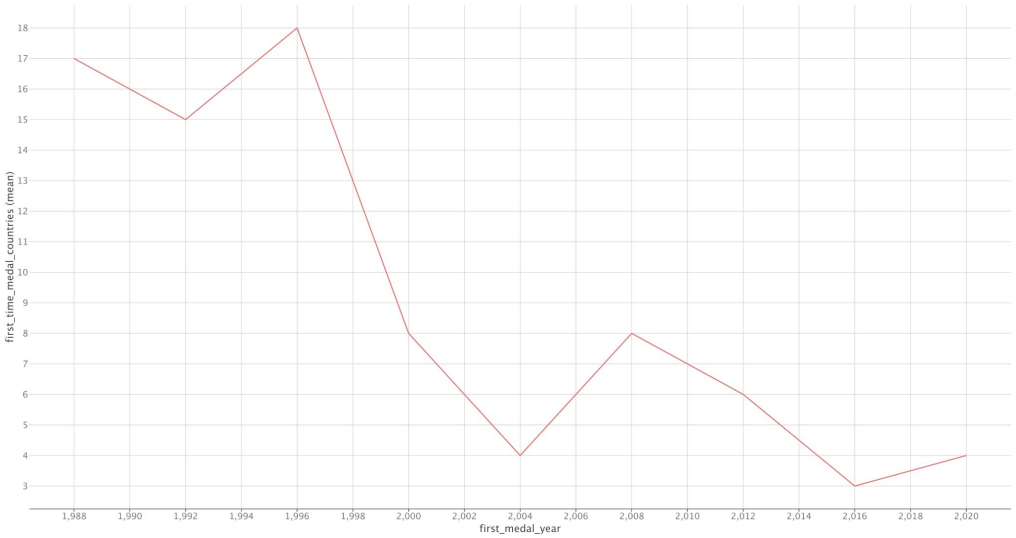


- Host medals
- Average non-host medals.

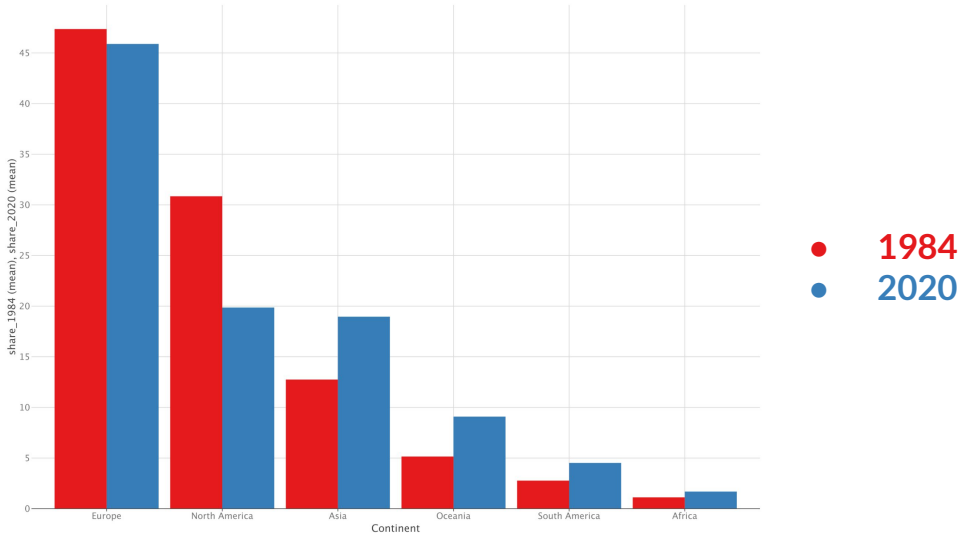
Global Expansion of Olympic Success

More countries entered the medal table over time, but global success remained uneven.

Which countries won their first medal during each Olympics?



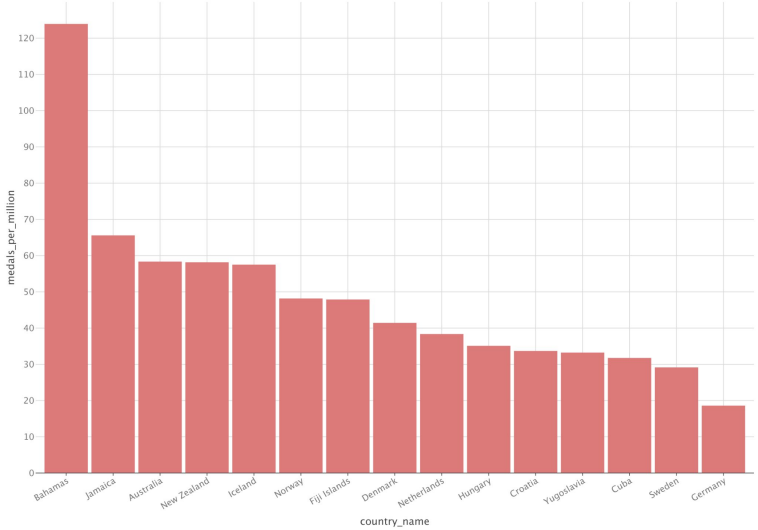
How did medal share by continent change from 1984 to 2020?



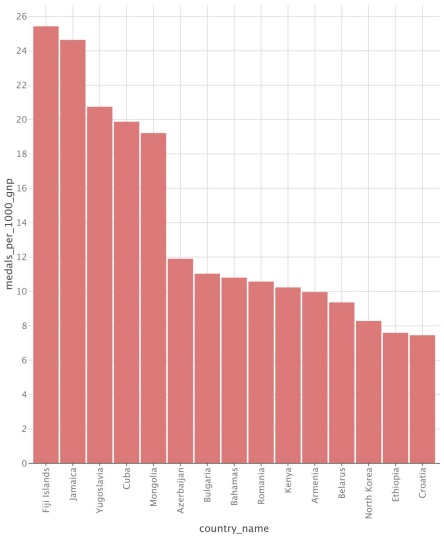
Country Context

Population and economy help explain medal totals, but adjusted measures reveal smaller overperformers.

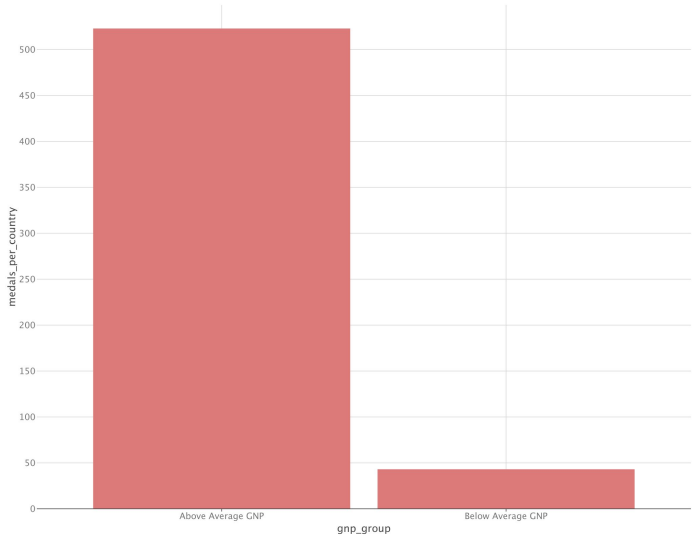
Which countries won the most medals per million people?



Which countries won the most medals relative to GNP?



Do countries with above-average GNP win more medals?



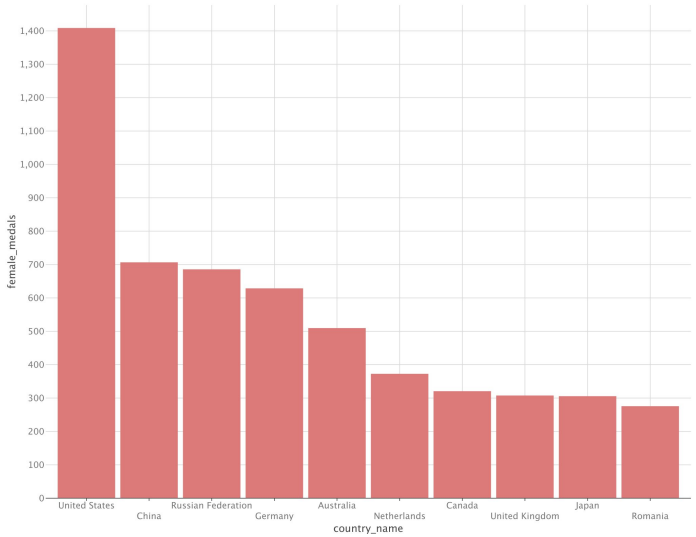
The Gender Revolution

Women's medal success became one of the clearest signs of change in the modern Olympics.

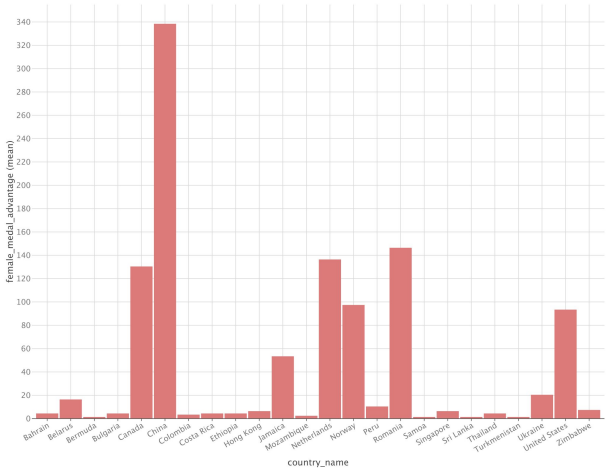
What is the overall male-to-female medalist ratio?

Male Medalists	Female Medalists	Mate to Female Ratio
11019	8375	1.32

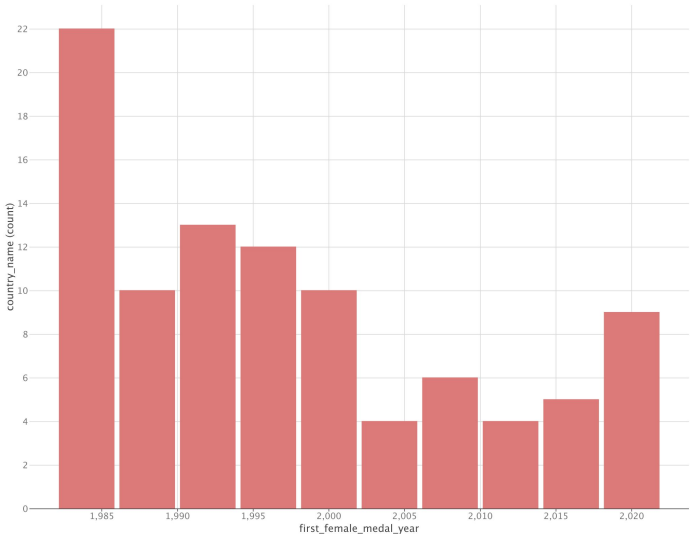
Which countries won the most female medals?



Which countries had more female medalists than male medalists?



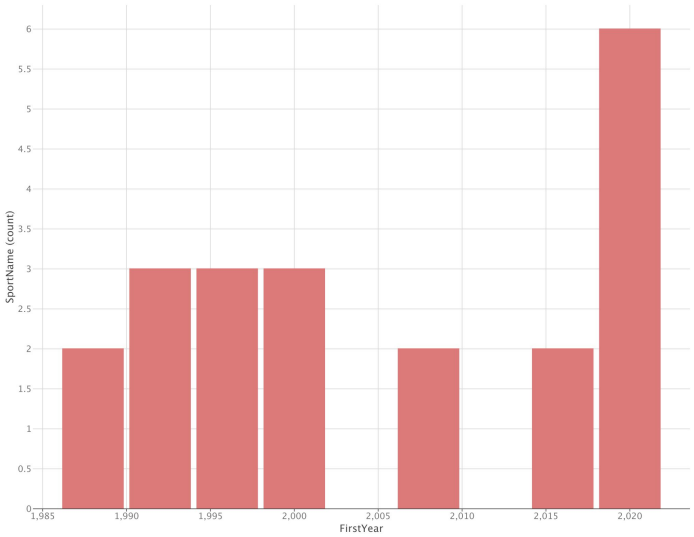
In what year did each country win its first female medal in our dataset?



New Sports, New Opportunities

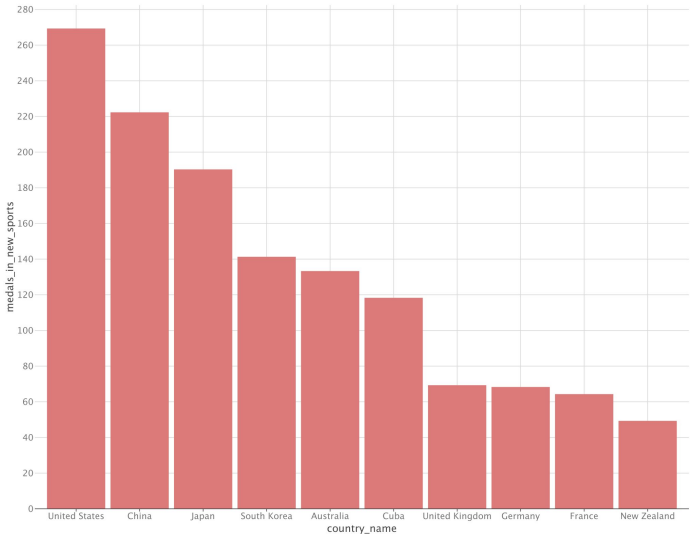
Changes to the Olympic program created new paths for countries to win and specialize.

Which sports were added after 1984?

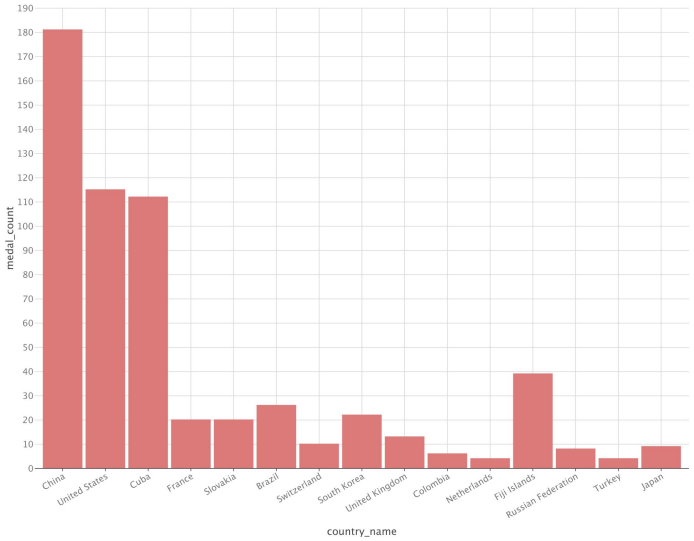


	SportName	FirstYear
1	Table Tennis	1988
2	Tennis	1988
3	Badminton	1992
4	Baseball	1992
5	Canoe Slalom	1992
6	Beach Volleyball	1996
7	Cycling Mountain Bike	1996
8	Softball	1996
9	Taekwondo	2000
10	Trampolining	2000
11	Triathlon	2000
12	Cycling BMX Racing	2008
13	Marathon Swimming	2008
14	Golf	2016
15	Rugby Sevens	2016
16	3x3 Basketball	2020
17	Cycling BMX Freestyle	2020
18	Karate	2020
19	Skateboarding	2020
20	Sport Climbing	2020
21	Surfing	2020

Which countries won the most medals in newly added sports?



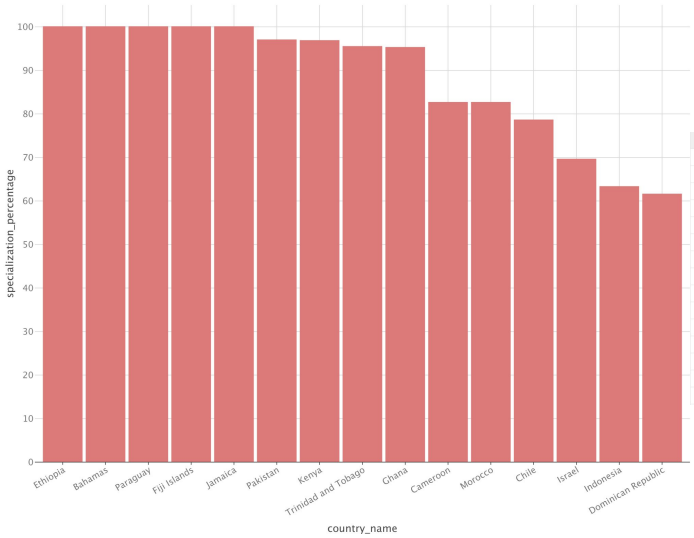
Which country dominated each newly added sport?



Country Specialization

Some countries succeed broadly, while others build Olympic identity around a small number of sports.

Which countries are most specialized in one sport?



	country_name	country_code	top_sport	top_sport_medals	total_medals	specialization_percentage
1	Ethiopia	ETH	Athletics	48	48	100.00
2	Bahamas	BHS	Athletics	38	38	100.00
3	Paraguay	PRY	Football	22	22	100.00
4	Fiji Islands	FJI	Rugby Sevens	39	39	100.00
5	Jamaica	JAM	Athletics	169	169	100.00
6	Pakistan	PAK	Hockey	32	33	96.97
7	Kenya	KEN	Athletics	91	94	96.81
8	Trinidad and Tobago	TTO	Athletics	21	22	95.45
9	Ghana	GHA	Football	20	21	95.24
10	Cameroon	CMR	Football	19	23	82.61
11	Morocco	MAR	Athletics	19	23	82.61
12	Chile	CHL	Football	22	28	78.57
13	Israel	ISR	Judo	16	23	69.57
14	Indonesia	IDN	Badminton	31	49	63.27
15	Dominican Republic	DOM	Baseball	24	39	61.54